

**INFLUENCE OF INTERGRATED MARKETING COMMUNICATIONS
ON STUDENT ENROLLMENT IN NEWLY ESTABLISHED PUBLIC
TVET INSTITUTIONS IN KIAMBU COUNTY, KENYA**

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DECLARATION

Student Declaration

This research proposal is my original work, and has not been submitted to any other institution of higher learning for examination.



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Supervisors' Declaration

This research proposal has been submitted for examination with our approval as the university supervisor.

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Acknowledgement

I thank God for His grace, which has brought me this far with this work. I am also deeply grateful to my supervisor, Dr. Edward Kobuthi, for his guidance, patience and direction throughout the preparation of this proposal.

ABSTRACT

Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) is widely seen as one of the main routes to industrialisation and youth employment, and it sits at the centre of Kenya Vision 2030. The government has invested heavily in the sector, both through policy reforms such as the TVET Act 2013 and by opening new institutions across the country. Even so, many of the newly established public TVET institutions, particularly in Kiambu County, still struggle to attract enough students. Two reasons are often given: the negative way society views technical training, and marketing efforts that are scattered and poorly coordinated. KCSE results show that at least thirty thousand form four leavers in Kiambu County could join TVET each year, yet this potential does not automatically turn into enrolment, and both public and private institutions have to rely on marketing to attract trainees. It is therefore important to find out whether a well-coordinated communication approach makes a difference to enrolment. The purpose of this study is to examine the influence of Integrated Marketing Communications (IMC) on student enrolment in newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya. Four specific objectives guide the study: to examine the influence of digital marketing, broadcast media, outdoor media and experiential outreach on student enrolment. The study draws on the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) and the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB), which together help explain how technology and social and personal factors shape decisions. A descriptive survey design will be used, targeting students and staff in six public TVET institutions in the county. Data will be collected through structured questionnaires and analysed using descriptive statistics, correlation and multiple regression, after diagnostic tests have confirmed that the data meet the assumptions of regression. The study is expected to show how each IMC channel, and the channels combined, contribute to enrolment. The findings should help TVET managers, policy makers and other stakeholders to plan better multi-channel marketing campaigns and, in the long run, strengthen the TVET sector as a response to youth unemployment and skills gaps in Kenya.

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS

Acronym / Abbreviation	Full Description
CAK	Communications Authority of Kenya
ECD	Early Childhood Development
ICT	Information and Communication Technology
IMC	Integrated Marketing Communication
KNBS	Kenya National Bureau of Statistics
KNEC	Kenya National Examination Council
MOE	Ministry of Education
SDTVET	State Department for Technical and Vocational Education and Training
SPSS	Statistical Package for the Social Sciences
TAM	Technology Acceptance Model
TPB	Theory of Planned Behavior
TVC	Technical and Vocational College
TVET	Technical and Vocational Education and Training
VIF	Variance Inflation Factor

CHAPTER ONE

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of the Study

Around the world, Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) is increasingly treated as an important driver of economic growth, industrialisation and job creation for young people. Bodies such as UNESCO and the World Bank have repeatedly pointed out that TVET gives learners practical, job-ready skills that respond to the changing needs of the labour market (UNESCO, 2022). In many developed countries, TVET institutions no longer simply offer courses and wait for applicants. They run carefully planned promotional campaigns across several channels to keep their numbers up and secure their future.

In Kenya, the place of TVET is set out in Kenya Vision 2030, which identifies the reform of technical training as a key engine of industrialisation and economic development. The sector is expected to give the workforce the technical, industrial and entrepreneurial skills that a modern economy needs (Government of Kenya, 2007). Over the past decade the government has pursued this goal through major reforms. These include the TVET Act of 2013, the move to Competency-Based Education and Training (CBET) curricula and the rapid construction of public TVET institutions in every sub-county. Led by the Ministry of Education, these initiatives have aimed to widen access, improve training facilities and strengthen quality assurance (Ministry of Education, 2021). The scale of this expansion shows a clear policy intention to make technical education a respected and preferred route to employment. However, such investment can only be justified if young people actually take up the training, and this is reflected in the numbers enrolled. For this reason, TVET institutions in Kiambu County have been marketing themselves in an effort to raise their enrolment and reach more of the county's population. Marketing can be understood as both a social process and a management activity through which value is created and exchanged to meet the needs of customers. Kotler and Armstrong (2012) describe it as the science and art of exploring, creating and delivering value to satisfy a target market at a profit. In practice, this value is

communicated through a mix of channels, each reaching people in a different way. Digital marketing builds personal relationships online, broadcast media reaches large audiences and builds a strong image, outdoor media keeps the brand visible in a particular locality, and experiential outreach creates lasting personal connections (Kotler and Keller, 2016). Much of modern education marketing relies on bringing these channels together under an Integrated Marketing Communications (IMC) approach. When an institution coordinates its digital marketing (websites, social media and bulk SMS), broadcast media (radio and television adverts or talk shows), outdoor media (billboards and banners) and community outreach (roadshows and school visits), it sends one consistent message. Managing these channels as one connected system, rather than as separate activities, can change how the public sees TVET, deepen engagement with prospective students and make marketing more effective, which in turn raises enrolment (World Bank, 2020).

The pattern of KCSE results in Kenya shows a large and growing demand for alternatives to university education. National examination data indicate that most secondary school leavers fall within the group that technical training is designed to serve. In 2023, out of 899,453 candidates, 698,320 scored a C plain or below and only 201,133 attained a C+ or above. In 2024, out of 962,512 candidates, 716,121 scored a C or below compared with 246,391 who met the university entry grade. By 2025, the number scoring C and below had reached 722,511 out of 993,226 candidates, while 270,715 scored C+ and above. Year after year, more than 70% of the national cohort falls into this group, and it is these school leavers who will make up much of Kenya's future workforce.

Fig 1.1 National KCSE Candidates Performance Data (2023–2025)]- Source KNEC

Year	Total Candidature	C+ and Above	C and Below
2023	899,453	201,133	698,320
2024	962,512	246,391	716,121

Year	Total Candidature	C+ and Above	C and Below
2025	993,226	270,715	722,511

These figures show how much room the TVET sector has to absorb, train and empower hundreds of thousands of young people each year, which makes the performance of technical institutions a matter of real social and economic importance. Yet enrolment in many public TVET institutions across Kenya remains well below their capacity. One of the most stubborn obstacles is the negative way in which society views vocational training (Ngure, 2023). For a long time, TVET has been seen as a fallback for learners who fail to secure a university place, and this view continues to shape the choices of young people and of the parents and guardians who pay their fees (Oketch, 2024). As a result, even where modern workshops have been built and flexible modular courses introduced, many colleges still find it hard to attract enough students. The gap between what policy intends and what is happening to enrolment raises questions about how well current promotional efforts are working and how well they are coordinated. It suggests that occasional publicity activities are not enough, and that institutions need structured and well-aligned communication.

Such communication would help to challenge cultural biases and change how the public sees technical training. The KCSE candidature and performance for Kiambu County in 2024 and 2025 is shown in Figure 1.2.

YEAR	2024	2025
MALE	18177	18749
FEMALE	20848	21469
TOTAL CANDIDATURE	39025	40218
C+ AND ABOVE	8806	9311
BELOW C+	30219	30907

Fig 1.2 Kiambu County KCSE performance data

The figures for these two years suggest that about thirty thousand young people in Kiambu County could join TVET every year.

With numbers like these, one would expect every TVET institution in Kiambu to fill its classes easily. In addition, there are thousands of out-of-school young people under the age of 30 who are neither in training nor in work, and all of them could potentially join a TVET institution. In reality, however, both public and private TVETs have to market themselves heavily to attract students. The challenge is sharper in a competitive and fast-urbanising county such as Kiambu. The newly established public colleges, namely Lari, Githunguri, Ruiru, Limuru, Gatundu and Nachu Technical and Vocational Colleges, face a difficult environment. They have to build a new brand while competing for the same local students with older institutions that are well known and widely trusted. Within the county, these new colleges operate in the shadow of large public institutions such as Thika Technical Training Institute and Kiambu National Polytechnic, as well as active private colleges such as NIBS Technical College (Wanjala & Were, 2019; KNBS, 2022). For young colleges that are still building their reputation and trying to stabilise their numbers, attracting students is an uphill task, since applicants naturally lean towards names they already know.

To cope with this competition and improve their intake, the new TVET colleges have started using a range of marketing methods. Most of these, however, are carried out separately from one another. Colleges visit high schools and take part in career days, put up banners in their localities and, increasingly, turn to digital platforms to take advantage of the county's high mobile internet use (Communications Authority of Kenya, 2023). These efforts are seldom planned together. Broadcast media, and especially local vernacular radio, is also under-used, even though it is one of the best ways to reach the parents and guardians who usually pay the fees.

Despite these separate promotional activities, low enrolment remains a serious risk for the colleges. This is clear from recent monitoring and baseline data compiled by the Ministry of Education’s State Department for TVET (Ministry of Education, 2025). The problem does not appear to be a lack of marketing activity. Rather, the continued shortfall points to a lack of coordination between the different communication channels. To address this gap, the present study examines the influence of an Integrated Marketing Communications (IMC) framework, made up of digital marketing, broadcast media, outdoor media and experiential outreach, on student enrolment in these newly established colleges. The data collected in October 2025 show the following numbers:

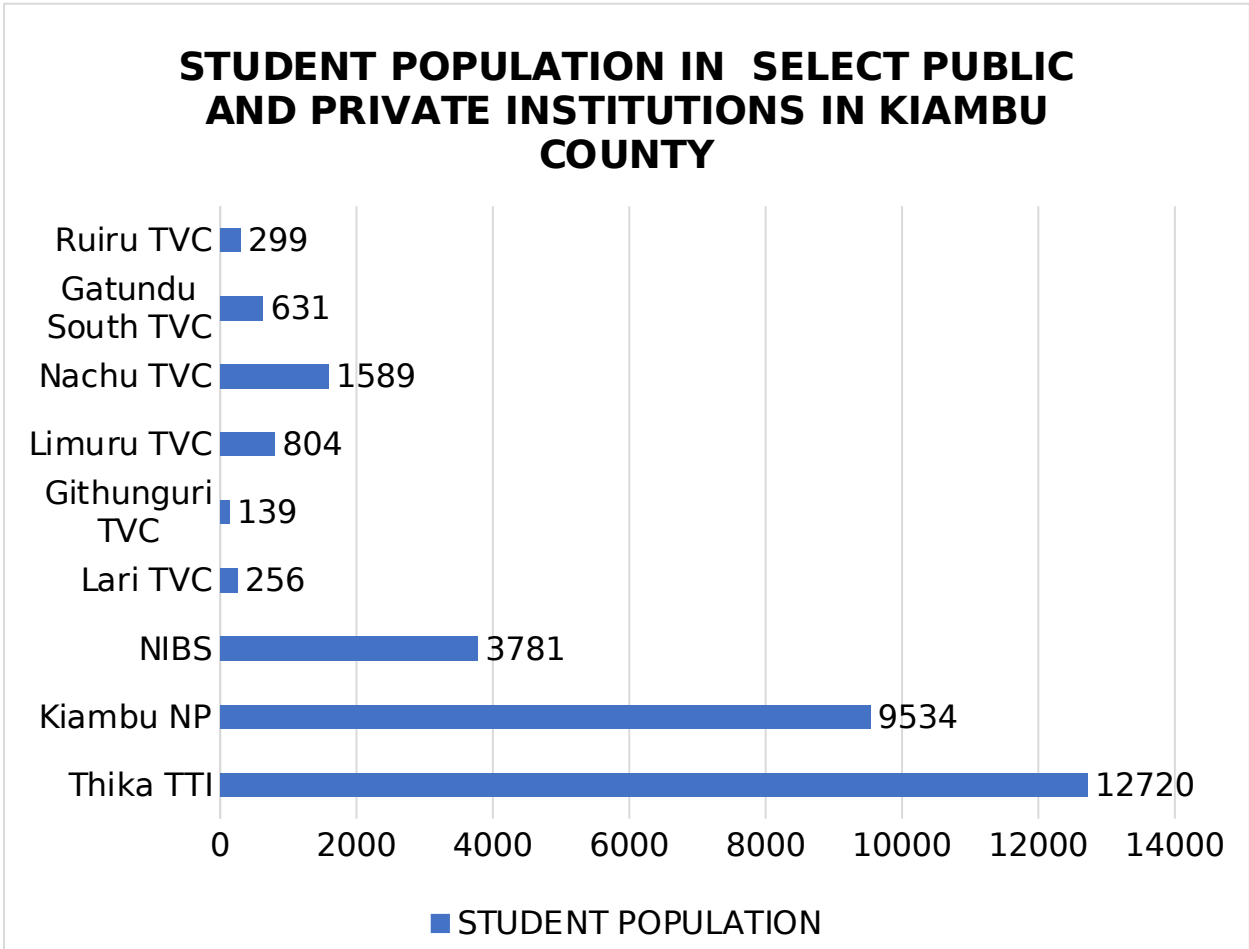


Figure 1.3: Enrolment Rates in Select TVET Institutions in Kiambu ***Source: Ministry of Education***

Although the newly established Technical and Vocational Colleges (TVCs) in Kiambu County serve important local communities, their enrolment is still low compared with the larger and older institutions in the region. Student numbers in the individual TVCs range from only 139 at Githunguri TVC to 1,589 at Nachu TVC. The older institutions are far bigger: NIBS has 3,781 students, Kiambu National Polytechnic has 9,534 and Thika Technical Training Institute has 12,720. The gap shows how much the new colleges lag behind the county's main training centres in their ability to attract students.

Part of the problem is that there is little clear evidence on how these communication channels work together, or which combinations bring in the most students. Many of the new colleges spend money on digital marketing, broadcast media, outdoor media and outreach at the same time, without knowing how well these efforts fit together or how cost-effective they are as a whole (Kotler & Keller, 2016). This scattered approach tends to waste limited resources, produce mixed messages and miss chances to recruit more students.

Without local evidence on how these four channels support each other, college principals and registrars cannot make well-informed decisions about how to plan and share out their marketing budgets (Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2019). The result is that low enrolment continues, putting the financial survival of the new colleges at risk and weakening the large public investment that the state has made in the TVET sector.

TVET remains central to Kenya's industrialisation agenda and to the achievement of Vision 2030. Its success, however, depends not only on sound policies and good infrastructure but also on how clearly and consistently institutions explain their value to the public. When training opportunities and modular CBET courses are not communicated in a clear, united and visible way, prospective students and their sponsors remain unaware of them. This contributes to a continuing mismatch between the skills being produced and those the labour market needs, which in turn fuels youth unemployment and slows economic progress in the region.

It is against this background that the present study seeks to evaluate the influence of Integrated Marketing Communications on student enrolment in newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya, looking at the separate and combined effects of digital marketing, broadcast media, outdoor media and experiential outreach. By producing local evidence, the study hopes to offer practical guidance on how the colleges can coordinate their marketing, use their resources better and achieve steady growth in enrolment.

1.2 Statement of the Problem

Ideally, TVET institutions should attract large numbers of students by clearly communicating how their programmes equip learners with practical, industry-relevant skills. With strong policy backing under Kenya Vision 2030 and a clear legal framework in the TVET Act 2013, Kenyan TVET institutions are expected to play a leading role in industrialisation, innovation and youth employment. In such a situation, the government's heavy investment in buildings, modern training equipment and new institutions across the country would lead to high enrolment, full use of facilities and a steady supply of skilled graduates for the labour market. The situation on the ground is quite different, even though there is a large local pool of potential TVET students. In Kiambu County, KCSE candidates who score between C- (minus) and E form the main target group for TVET diploma, craft certificate and artisan courses. National examination statistics show that thousands of school leavers in the county fall into this group every year. Yet, even with this steady supply of potential students close by, enrolment in local colleges remains low. The newly established colleges, namely Lari, Githunguri, Ruiru, Limuru, Gatundu South and Nachu Technical and Vocational Colleges, are still operating well below capacity. According to Ministry of Education guidelines, a TVC should have at least 1,500 students by its third year of operation, as shown in the figure below:

Figure 1.4

Classification	National	Annual	trainee	Total Trainee Target
Government public TVETs		Enrolment	Intake	(Overall Headcount)
		Target per year		
National Polytechnic		3,000 – 6,000		10,000 – 18,000
Technical Training Institutes and Institutes of Science and Technology		2,000 - 5,000		8,000 – 15,000
Technical and Vocational Colleges (TVC)		500 – 1,500		1,500 – 4,000

Of the institutions in this study, only Nachu TVC has reached this minimum level. The others, although opened at about the same time, are still far behind. Even Nachu, which has been running for five years, is only just at the minimum. Part of the problem is likely to be the long-standing belief that vocational education is a second-best option for students who miss a university place, which leads many families to overlook its value. At the same time, the new colleges face stiff competition from older public institutions such as Thika Technical Training Institute and Kiambu National Polytechnic, and from active private colleges such as NIBS Technical College, all of which are well known and widely trusted.

To reverse this trend and attract local KCSE candidates, college managers have used a variety of promotional methods. These include digital marketing (social media, WhatsApp groups and websites), mass media advertising (local radio and television), outdoor branding (billboards and gate branding) and direct outreach (roadshows, school visits and career days). These activities show that the colleges are trying to raise their profile, but they are usually carried out separately rather than as part of a coordinated Integrated Marketing Communications (IMC) plan. As a

result, the messages are scattered and do little to move prospective students from first hearing about a college to actually enrolling.

The problem, therefore, is not only that enrolment is low despite a large pool of eligible KCSE candidates, but also that little is known about how each IMC channel, and the channels together, affect students' decisions to enrol. Most existing studies look at traditional or digital marketing on its own, and mostly in large companies or established universities. Very little is known about how digital, broadcast, outdoor and experiential strategies work together in newly established public TVET colleges with limited resources. These colleges have been in operation for between three and eight years, as shown in the table below:

Figure 1.5 Operational timelines of Newly established TVETs in Kiambu County

Institution and location	Year of Establishment	Key Operational Milestones
Nachu TVC (Kikuyu)	2018	Admitted its pioneer batch of trainees in July 2018.
Gatundu South TVC (Gatundu)	2019	Groundwork completed under the constituency TVET drive; began receiving official KUCCPS student placements in 2019
Lari TVC (Lari)	2019	Officially opened its doors and commenced academic operations in September 2019 .
Limuru TVC (Limuru Kamandura)	2020	Registered under TVETA and opened for its pioneer student intake in 2020 .

Institution and location	Year of Establishment	Key Operational Milestones
Githunguri TVC (<i>Githunguri Marige</i>)	2020	Fully operational since 2020
Ruiru TVC (<i>Ruiru</i>)	2023	Established under the expanded national TVET program; operational since 2023 .

Without reliable evidence, college managers are left to rely on guesswork. They may end up spending scarce public funds on disconnected promotional activities that bring in few students, while expensive training facilities remain under-used.

This study therefore seeks to fill this gap by evaluating the influence of Integrated Marketing Communications, made up of digital marketing, broadcast media, outdoor media and experiential outreach, on student enrolment in newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya. The findings will give TVET managers and policy makers evidence on how best to combine these channels so as to attract more of the available secondary school leavers. Raising enrolment is important for reducing youth unemployment, closing the national skills gap and realising the full benefits of Kenya's reforms in technical education.

1.3 Objectives of the Study

1.3.1 General Objective

The general objective of this study is to investigate the influence of Integrated Marketing Communications on student enrollment in newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya.

1.3.2 Specific Objectives

The study will be guided by the following specific objectives:

1. To evaluate the influence of digital marketing strategies on student enrollment in newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya.
2. To assess the influence of broadcast media advertising on student enrollment in newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya.
3. To analyze the influence of outdoor media advertising on student enrollment in newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya.
4. To determine the influence of experiential outreach strategies on student enrollment in newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya.

1.4 Research Questions

The study will be guided by the following research questions:

1. What is the influence of digital marketing strategies on student enrollment in newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya?
2. What is the influence of broadcast media advertising on student enrollment in newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya?
3. What is the influence of outdoor media advertising on student enrollment in newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya?
4. What is the influence of experiential outreach strategies on student enrollment in newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya?

1.5 Significance of the Study

The study is expected to contribute to both policy and practice in Kenya's TVET sector in the following ways.

First, it will be useful to principals and managers of newly established public TVET colleges, especially in Kiambu County. By showing how well a coordinated, multi-channel marketing approach works, the study will help them decide how to combine and share out their limited marketing budgets. Rather than relying on trial and error, they will be in a better position to plan a coordinated marketing mix that raises enrolment and strengthens the future of their institutions.

Secondly, the findings will be useful to policy makers in the Ministry of Education and in agencies responsible for TVET, such as the TVET Authority (TVETA) and the TVET Curriculum Development, Assessment and Certification Council (TVET CDACC). Under frameworks such as Kenya Vision 2030, the government has invested heavily in new TVET institutions in the hope that they will train large numbers of young people in competency-based skills. Low enrolment puts this investment at risk. The study will provide evidence that can guide national policies, strategic plans and common guidelines on student recruitment and branding in public TVET institutions.

Prospective students, parents and the wider community will also benefit. By identifying the channels through which information about TVET reaches people most effectively, the study can help to raise awareness and understanding of vocational education. This matters because TVET is still widely seen as a poor alternative to university. If colleges can communicate their value clearly through digital, broadcast, outdoor and face-to-face channels working together, students and parents may come to appreciate the economic value of technical skills, and this could lead to higher enrolment and better career choices.

The study will also add to academic knowledge. Although research on education marketing and student enrolment is growing, few studies have looked at how Integrated Marketing Communications is applied, and with what effect, in newly established public TVET institutions in Kenya. By addressing this gap, the study will offer a reference point for future research on related topics such as institutional competitiveness, how students choose where to study and the role of promotion in the performance of public institutions.

Finally, the study has wider social and economic value. Raising enrolment in TVET institutions is not only in the interest of individual colleges; it is closely tied to national development goals. A well-enrolled and well-run TVET sector helps to build a skilled technical workforce, reduce youth unemployment and close the gap between what education produces and what industry needs. The results of this study are therefore expected to support both the growth of the colleges and Kenya's long-term development agenda.

1.6 Scope of the Study

This study examines how Integrated Marketing Communications influence student enrolment in newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya. It focuses on six newly operational colleges: Lari, Githunguri, Ruiru, Limuru, Gatundu and Nachu Technical and Vocational Colleges. These colleges are a suitable setting for the study because, although they have modern training facilities, they share the same difficulty in attracting, enrolling and keeping students.

In terms of content, the study is limited to one independent variable, Integrated Marketing Communications (IMC), which is broken down into four parts:

- **Digital Marketing:** This covers social media activity, college websites, WhatsApp groups and online adverts.
- **Broadcast Media Advertising:** This covers television adverts, spots on vernacular and national radio stations, and appearances on talk shows.
- **Outdoor Media Advertising:** This covers highway billboards, branding on college gates, roadside banners and the distribution of flyers.
- **Experiential Outreach Strategies:** This covers direct, face-to-face activities such as career days, school visits, market roadshows and community *baraza* meetings.

The dependent variable is student enrolment. It will be measured through yearly registration trends, the programmes students choose and the communication channels that led to their final decision to enrol. Other aspects of college management, such as student retention, academic performance and the quality of training, are not part of this study, so that the analysis remains focused.

Geographically, the study is limited to Kiambu County. Its findings may offer useful lessons for other parts of Kenya where TVET is expanding, but they will be interpreted within the context of Kiambu, a county with strong competition among training institutions, wide reach of local media and high digital connectivity.

In terms of time, the study will focus on marketing practices and enrolment trends between **2024 and 2026**. This ensures that the data reflect the conditions and policies that public TVET institutions in Kenya are currently working under.

1.7 OPERATIONAL DEFINITION OF TERMS

Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET)

Education and training that gives learners the practical skills, knowledge and competencies needed for particular trades, occupations and careers. In this study, TVET refers to the public technical training sub-sector in Kiambu County that offers competency-based, skills-oriented programmes.

Technical and Vocational College (TVC)

A public institution mandated to offer technical and vocational training at artisan, certificate and diploma levels. In this study, TVCs are the six public colleges in Kiambu County under study: Lari, Githunguri, Ruiru, Limuru, Gatundu and Nachu Technical and Vocational Colleges.

Integrated Marketing Communications (IMC) Framework

A planned approach in which several communication channels are managed together so that they deliver one clear, consistent and persuasive message about a college's programmes. In this study, IMC is made up of four parts, namely digital marketing, broadcast media, outdoor media and experiential outreach, which are assessed for their combined influence on enrolment.

Digital Marketing Strategies

The use of online platforms and digital tools to make a college visible, build its brand and interact with prospective students. In this study, it refers to the management of college websites, search engine presence, social media platforms (such as Facebook, TikTok and WhatsApp), online adverts, and bulk SMS or email messages.

Broadcast Media Strategies

The spreading of promotional messages through radio and television. In this study, it refers to adverts, talk shows and feature programmes on national and local vernacular radio stations, and on mainstream or community television.

Outdoor Media Strategies

Physical advertising placed in busy public places so that the college stays visible in the area. In this study, it refers to signboards, billboards, banners, posters and brochures placed or distributed in high-traffic areas of Kiambu County.

Experiential Outreach Strategies

Direct, face-to-face promotional activities that allow prospective students and those who influence them to experience what TVET offers. In this study, it includes career days, visits to secondary schools, community awareness meetings, roadshows and caravans.

Student Enrollment

The process by which prospective learners formally register and join a technical institution, and the number who do so. In this study, it is measured by the number of applications received, the number of admissions made and the actual number of students registered in the selected TVCs each year.

Marketing Effectiveness

How far individual or combined communication strategies succeed in influencing the decisions of prospective students. In this study, it is judged by students' awareness, the number of enquiries received and students' own reports of how the IMC channels influenced their decision to enrol.

Perception of TVET

The attitudes, beliefs and opinions that students, parents and the community hold about the status, career value and quality of technical education. In this study, it refers to how these views shape the way people respond to a college's IMC campaigns.

Digital Engagement

How often and how deeply prospective students interact with a TVC's online platforms. In this study, it is shown by actions such as time spent on the website, online enquiry forms submitted, direct messages sent, and likes, shares or comments on the college's social media pages.

Newly Established TVETs

TVET institutions set up by the National Government through the State Department for TVET within the last eight years. In this study, they are the colleges in Kiambu County that have been in operation for between three and eight years.

1.8 Limitations of the Study

Limitations are weaknesses or constraints outside the researcher's control that could affect the findings. The following are anticipated:

1.8.1 Self-Reporting and Recall Bias: The study relies on what trainees and registrars report about which IMC channels (digital, broadcast, outdoor or experiential) influenced enrolment. Students may not remember accurately, or may choose answers that seem more acceptable. To reduce this, the questionnaire will include related questions that allow responses to be cross-checked.

1.8.2 Administrative and Institutional Data Constraints: Past enrolment figures and marketing budgets in the new colleges may not have been recorded consistently, since record-keeping is often weak in an institution's early years. The researcher will therefore supplement the survey data with official baseline reports from the Ministry of Education's State Department for TVET.

1.8.3 Contextual and Environmental Dynamics: Factors outside marketing, such as economic conditions that affect parents' ability to pay fees, delays in government funding (for example HELB or HEF processing) and changes in university entry grades, may also affect enrolment. The researcher will take these factors into account when interpreting and discussing the results.

1.9 Assumptions of the Study

Assumptions are conditions that are taken to be true, without proof, so that the study can proceed. The study makes the following assumptions:

- 1.9.1 Authenticity of Respondent Feedback:** That respondents, including TVC administrators, marketing officers and students, will answer honestly and accurately about their exposure to IMC channels and their reasons for enrolling.
- 1.9.2 Active Execution of IMC Tactics:** That all six colleges (Nachu, Lari, Githunguri, Ruiru, Limuru and Gatundu South TVCs) used at least two of the IMC channels (digital, broadcast, outdoor or experiential) during the 2024–2026 study period.
- 1.9.3 Stability of the Regulatory Environment:** That the rules governing admission to public TVET institutions, such as KUCCPS placement criteria and TVETA regulations, will remain fairly stable during data collection and analysis.
- 1.9.4 Sample Representativeness:** That the trainees and staff sampled from the six TVCs fairly represent the wider population of newly established public technical colleges in Kiambu County.

1.10 Delimitations of the Study

Delimitations are the boundaries that the researcher has deliberately set for the study. They are as follows:

- 1.10.1 Geographical and Institutional Scope:** The study is limited to six newly established public Technical and Vocational Colleges in Kiambu County (Lari, Githunguri, Ruiru, Limuru, Gatundu South and Nachu TVCs). Older, well-established institutions (such as Kiambu National Polytechnic and Thika TTI) and private colleges (such as NIBS) are left out so that the sample is made up only of young public TVCs that have been running for three to eight years.
- 1.10.2 Conceptual Scope:** The study focuses on the Integrated Marketing Communications (IMC) framework, broken down into four independent

variables: *Digital Marketing, Broadcast Media, Outdoor Media* and *Experiential Outreach*. Other parts of the marketing mix, such as fees, the quality of physical facilities and course content, are outside the scope of the study.

1.10.3 Dependent Variable Focus: The study measures *student enrollment outcomes*, that is, the number of applications, intake trends and the channels that led students to enrol. Wider outcomes such as graduate employment, retention and academic performance are deliberately left out.

1.10.4 Temporal Scope: The study covers promotional activities and enrolment trends between **2024 and 2026**. Data from before 2024 will be used only as background.

CHAPTER TWO

LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Introduction

This chapter reviews the literature on marketing communications and student enrolment in TVET institutions. It discusses the theories on which the study is based, reviews empirical studies on each dimension of integrated marketing communications, and identifies the gaps that remain in the context of newly established public TVETs in Kiambu County.

2.2 Theoretical Framework

The study is based on two theories that together explain how promotion influences students' decisions to join technical institutions: the **Technology Acceptance Model (TAM)** and the **Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB)**. TAM helps to explain how prospective students respond to digital channels, while TPB helps to explain the social and personal factors that shape the choices of applicants and of the parents and guardians who pay their fees.

2.2.1 Technology Acceptance Model (TAM)

The Technology Acceptance Model (TAM), introduced by Fred Davis in 1989, is one of the most widely used frameworks for explaining how people come to accept

and use new technology. According to TAM, a person's intention to use a technology, and their actual use of it, depend on two beliefs. The first is Perceived Usefulness (PU), which is the degree to which a person believes the technology will help them achieve what they want. The second is Perceived Ease of Use (PEOU), which is how free of effort they expect it to be. When people find an online platform both useful and easy to use, they develop a positive attitude towards it and are more likely to use it.

In education marketing, TAM helps to explain how prospective students behave online. If a college's website or online platform is cluttered, slow or hard to navigate, students are likely to leave it, however good the training inside the college may be.

In this study, TAM supports the first independent variable, **Digital Marketing**. As the new public TVET colleges in Kiambu County use social media campaigns, WhatsApp groups and official websites to reach prospective students, the way these platforms are designed will affect how many students they attract. If a college website presents courses, fees and online application links clearly (high PEOU), and shows how each course leads to a job (high PU), young people who are comfortable with technology are much more likely to complete their applications.

2.2.2 Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB)

The Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB), developed by Icek Ajzen in 1991, holds that behaviour is driven by intention, and that intention is shaped by three factors. The first is attitude towards the behaviour, meaning a person's own positive or negative view of it. The second is subjective norms, meaning the pressure a person feels from important others such as parents, friends and community leaders. The third is perceived behavioural control, meaning how easy or difficult the person thinks it will be to carry out the behaviour, given the resources and obstacles they face.

TPB recognises that major life decisions, such as the choice of what and where to study, are not made in isolation from culture. In Kenya, vocational education has long carried a negative image and has often been seen as a last resort for students who fail to get a university place (Sifuna, 2020). This creates strong subjective

norms against TVET and discourages capable young people from joining public TVET colleges, even when modern facilities are available close to home.

For this reason, promotion cannot simply provide information; it must also change social attitudes and build confidence. This is where the non-digital parts of an Integrated Marketing Communications framework, namely Broadcast Media, Outdoor Media and Experiential Outreach, become important. Testimonials on local radio can ease the worries of parents, who usually decide whether fees will be paid. In the same way, career days and roadshows raise students' confidence by letting them see the training equipment for themselves and by clearing up questions about admission within their own communities.

2.3 Empirical Literature Review

2.3.1 Influence of Digital Marketing Strategies on Student Enrollment

Around the world, digital marketing has changed the way institutions recruit students. Many institutions now rely on search engine optimisation, social media and email campaigns to attract applicants. Chaffey and Ellis-Chadwick (2019) point out that digital marketing allows institutions to target specific audiences and to track results in detail, which traditional media cannot do. Constantinides and Stagno (2011) show that today's students treat an institution's online presence as their main source of information, and rely heavily on reviews and interactive content when choosing where to study.

In developing countries, digital channels are growing quickly, although they face particular limitations. In Ghana, Boateng and Okoe (2015) observe that platforms such as Facebook and WhatsApp have become informal marketplaces where institutions interact directly with prospective students. In South Africa, Mpinganjira (2014) notes that digital platforms give new colleges a cheap and fast way to reach large numbers of young people. However, unreliable internet connections, poorly managed content and low digital skills often reduce the returns on these investments.

In Kenya, the rapid spread of smartphones and the internet has changed how education is promoted. Data from the Communications Authority of Kenya (2026) show that most young Kenyans are active users of digital media, which makes

online outreach essential for public institutions. Even so, Kibet and Muturi (2020) found that many public institutions run poorly managed online platforms, with outdated websites and inactive social media accounts.

Although these general trends are well documented, little is known about how newly established public TVET colleges in Kiambu County, such as Nachu or Lari TVCs, use targeted digital marketing to make up for their short history and attract students.

2.3.2 Influence of Broadcast Media Advertising on Student Enrollment

Broadcast advertising on television and radio is a strong tool for creating wide awareness of an institution and earning public trust. Around the world, higher education institutions use broadcast campaigns to build prestige and make their names easy to remember. Hemsley-Brown and Oplatka (2015) observe that broadcast adverts give institutions legitimacy and suggest stability and size to the public.

In Sub-Saharan Africa, broadcast media, and radio in particular, remains a vital source of local information. Maringe (2006) notes that in areas where literacy levels vary, radio overcomes the barrier of the written word and reaches several generations at once. In rural and peri-urban areas, radio carries considerable social authority, and listeners often associate an appearance on radio with official approval.

In Kenya, vernacular radio stations such as Kameme FM and Inooro FM, which are popular in the Central region, have strong cultural influence. Ngure (2013) notes that parents and community elders, who are the main sponsors of young people's education, rely heavily on vernacular radio for information they trust. Public TVETs sometimes use radio talk shows or short adverts during the admission season, but Wanjala and Were (2019) argue that such campaigns are rarely assessed to establish how much they actually contribute to enrolment.

There is, therefore, a gap in knowledge about how newly established TVETs in Kiambu County can make systematic use of broadcast media to reach the parents and guardians who decide where prospective students will study.

2.3.3 Influence of Outdoor Media Advertising on Student Enrollment

Outdoor advertising, including roadside billboards, banners and gate branding, gives a college a permanent physical presence in its locality. Institutions around the world use outdoor displays to mark their presence and keep their names in people's minds along busy routes. Ivy (2008) notes that eye-catching outdoor displays build familiarity over time and make an institution feel like a permanent part of the local landscape.

In developing countries, outdoor branding is especially important for new institutions that are not yet well known. Adewale et al. (2018) observe that well-placed billboards and a smart, clearly marked gate show the community that a new public institution is complete, equipped and officially open. On the other hand, an unmarked or poorly kept entrance can suggest neglect or even raise doubts about accreditation.

In Kenya, public TVET facilities have increased rapidly, yet many of the new colleges are located away from the main roads in their sub-counties. Billboards along major Kiambu roads, such as the Thika Superhighway and Limuru Road, and branding at college gates are used to show that the colleges exist, but their actual effect on enrolment has not been measured.

Most studies on education marketing concentrate on digital channels and pay little attention to how local outdoor media influence the enrolment decisions of nearby communities. This study seeks to fill that gap.

2.3.4 Influence of Experiential Outreach Strategies on Student Enrollment

Experiential outreach refers to direct, face-to-face activities such as career days, open days, school visits and market roadshows, and it is the most personal form of education marketing. Kotler and Fox (1995) argue that personal contact is particularly good at turning uncertain prospects into committed applicants, because questions can be answered on the spot and people can be reassured in person.

In developing countries, experiential marketing is an important way of building trust. Oketch (2016) notes that in communities that have long doubted the value of technical training, bringing current students, trainers and equipment into public view helps to break down resistance. Such outreach moves the conversation from general descriptions to real, visible skills.

In Kenya, newly established technical colleges rely heavily on roadshows, visits to secondary schools and community *barazas* organised with local administrators. According to Ngure (2013), such events are very effective in challenging the “blue-collar stigma” because families can see modern training equipment for themselves. However, as Kibet and Muturi (2020) note, these field activities are seldom part of a wider, evidence-based strategy and often take place as one-off events without any system for following up interested students.

Little is known about how such outreach, when coordinated with digital and media campaigns, leads to lasting increases in enrolment for new TVET colleges in Kiambu County.

2.3.5 Summary of Literature and Research Gaps

The global and local studies reviewed recognise the separate value of digital tools, broadcast media, outdoor signage and face-to-face community engagement, but the literature as a whole remains fragmented.

Most studies on education marketing deal with long-established universities or private colleges that have their own marketing departments, and very little attention has been given to newly established public TVET colleges with tight budgets. In addition, earlier local studies tend to assess promotional methods one at a time, or simply compare traditional and digital methods.

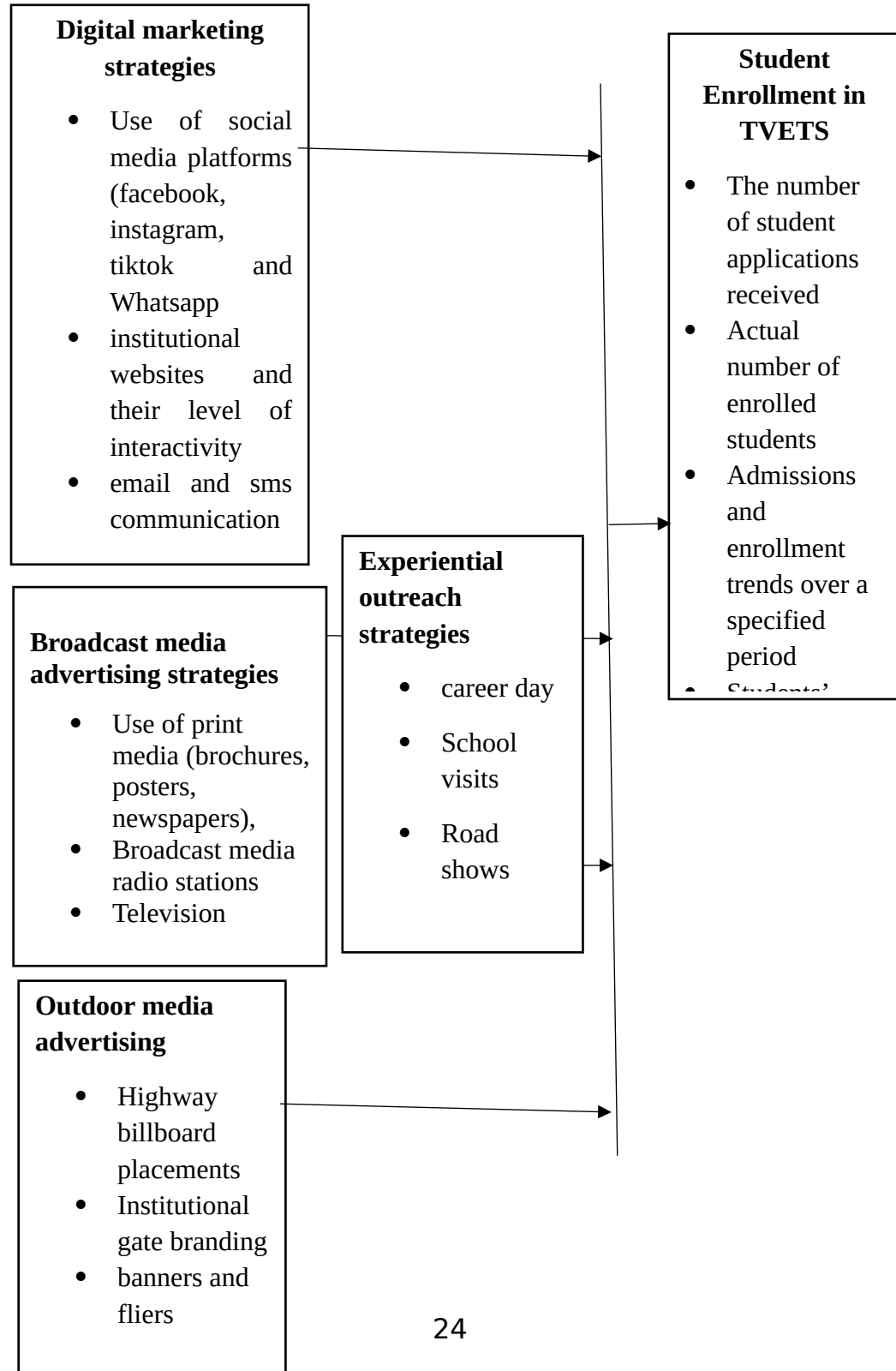
There is a clear shortage of research that treats these channels as one **Integrated Marketing Communications (IMC)** system in Kenya’s vocational training sector. This study addresses that gap by assessing, in a local setting, how digital, broadcast, outdoor and experiential strategies together influence student enrolment in public TVET institutions in Kiambu County.

2.4 Conceptual Framework

The conceptual framework shows the relationship between the independent and dependent variables. The independent variables are the four parts of Integrated Marketing Communications (IMC): Digital Marketing, Broadcast Media Advertising, Outdoor Media Advertising and Experiential Outreach Strategies. The dependent variable is student enrolment in newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya. The framework assumes that the way

colleges coordinate and use these channels affects how aware prospective students are, how they view TVET and, in the end, whether they decide to enrol.

2.1: Conceptual Framework for IMC and Student Enrollment



The study has four independent variables, all of which fall under Integrated Marketing Communications.

1. **Digital Marketing** refers to the planned use of websites and online applications to reach and engage prospective students where they spend time online.
2. **Broadcast Media Advertising** refers to messages sent through radio and television, which give a college wide public visibility and appeal to the parents and guardians who pay for education.
3. **Outdoor Media Advertising** refers to physical signs placed along busy routes to establish the college's presence in the local community.
4. **Experiential Outreach Strategies** refer to face-to-face activities at community level that allow college staff to speak directly with prospective students.

The dependent variable is **Student Enrollment**, which reflects the combined result of these marketing efforts across the colleges studied.

To make the framework measurable, each variable is broken down into specific indicators:

- **Digital Marketing** is measured by how often the colleges post on social media (Facebook, Instagram, TikTok), how easy their websites are to use, how active their WhatsApp groups are and how quickly they respond to online enquiries.
- **Broadcast Media Advertising** is measured by how often and for how long the colleges appear on air, with attention to local radio stations (such as Kameme and Inooro), television appearances and talk-show features.
- **Outdoor Media Advertising** is measured by the visibility of roadside billboards along major roads, the size and quality of gate branding, and the local distribution of banners and printed leaflets.
- **Experiential Outreach Strategies** are measured by the colleges' participation in local career days, visits to secondary schools, market-day roadshows and community meetings (*barazas*).

- **Student Enrollment** is measured by the number of applications received, the number of students admitted, year-to-year registration trends and the channels that students say influenced them at the time of admission.

The framework assumes that although each of the four channels can influence enrolment on its own, their greatest effect comes when they are used together. For example, a prospective student may first notice a roadside billboard (outdoor media), then listen to a presentation at a market fair (experiential outreach), later hear a programme on a vernacular radio station together with a parent (broadcast media), and finally apply through an online link (digital marketing).

2.5 Operationalization of Study Variables

Table 2.1 shows how each independent and dependent variable will be measured and analysed in the study.

Table 2.1: Operationalization Matrix

S n.	Specific Objective	Independent Variable	Indicators	Measurement Scale	Statistical Analysis
1.	To evaluate the influence of digital marketing strategies on student enrollment	Digital Marketing	Social network frequency (Facebook, TikTok) Website accessibility/usability WhatsApp/SMS group tracking Inquiry response times	Ordinal (5-Point Likert Scale tracking extent of use & perceived influence)	Descriptive statistics (Mean, Std. Dev), Correlation, Regression Analysis
2.	To assess the influence of broadcast media advertising	Broadcast Media	Airtime frequency on local radio TV promotional spot placements	Ordinal (5-Point Likert Scale tracking extent of use & perceived	Descriptive statistics (Mean, Std. Dev), Correlation, Regression Analysis

	g on student enrollment		Audio-visual feature profiles Estimated broadcast audience reach	influence)	
3.	To analyze the influence of outdoor media advertising on student enrollment	Outdoor Media	Highway billboard presence Institution gate branding quality Regional banner placement density Informational brochure footprint	Ordinal (5-Point Likert Scale tracking extent of use & perceived influence)	Descriptive statistics (Mean, Std. Dev), Correlation, Regression Analysis
4.	To determine the influence of experiential outreach strategies on student enrollment	Experiential Outreach	Career days participation Targeted high school circuits Active market roadshows/caravans Grassroots community barazas	Ordinal (5-Point Likert Scale tracking extent of use & perceived influence)	Descriptive statistics (Mean, Std. Dev), Correlation, Regression Analysis
Unified Outcome Dimension		Dependent Variable	Indicators	Measurement scale	Statistical analysis
	(Applies across all objectives)	Student Enrollment	Annual application volumes Actual student	Ratio (Actual administrative registration)	Frequencies, Percentages, Means, and Standard Deviations for

			admissions numbers	counts and intake statistics)	totals and distributions.
			Course enrollment distribution		Pearson Correlation Analysis
			Self-reported primary intake trigger		Multiple Linear Regression Analysis

CHAPTER THREE: RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Introduction

This chapter explains the methods that will be used to study how integrated marketing communications influence enrolment in newly established public technical and vocational colleges (TVCs). It sets out the research design, the target population, the sampling approach and the data collection instruments. It also describes how the data will be analysed, how the instruments will be tested and the ethical safeguards that will be observed.

3.2 Research Design

The study will use a **descriptive survey research design**. This design is suitable when a researcher wants to observe and describe a situation as it naturally occurs, without changing anything in the environment.

A descriptive survey will allow the researcher to collect information on marketing practices and student motivations from several colleges at the same point in time. It is well suited to education marketing research because it helps to answer questions about what promotional activities students were exposed to, where and how. It will also allow the study to identify patterns and to measure how strongly particular communication channels are related to students' decisions to register.

3.3 Target Population

The target population is the whole group of people who have the characteristics needed to answer the research questions. In this study, it is made up of two groups of

people in the six newly established TVCs in Kiambu County (Lari, Githunguri, Ruiru, Limuru, Gatundu and Nachu).

The population will include both students and administrative staff of these newly established public TVET institutions. Including both groups is a deliberate choice. Administrative staff, especially principals, marketing officers and admissions officers, plan and carry out marketing in their colleges, so they can explain the methods used, the difficulties faced and how well the methods seem to work. Students, on the other hand, are the people these efforts are aimed at, and they are best placed to say what led them to enrol. Combining the two views will give a more balanced and realistic picture of how marketing works in practice.

The study will focus on six newly established public TVET institutions in Kiambu County, namely Lari, Githunguri, Ruiru, Limuru, Gatundu and Nachu Technical and Vocational Colleges. They were chosen because they are relatively new and are all facing difficulties with enrolment, which makes them suitable for studying the influence of marketing. In estimating the population, it is assumed that each college has one principal and about four officers in charge of marketing and admissions. The number of students is estimated from available records and typical enrolment in newly established colleges, at an average of about 100 to 110 students per college. This gives an estimated total population of 654 respondents across the six colleges.

Table 3.1 Target Population by Institution

Institution	Principals	Marketing/Admissions Officers	Students Total	
Lari TVC	1	4	104	109
Githunguri TVC	1	4	105	110
Ruiru TVC	1	4	104	109
Limuru TVC	1	4	103	108
Gatundu TVC	1	4	104	109
Nachu TVC	1	4	104	109
Total	6	24	624	654

This population is appropriate because it covers both sides of the question: what the colleges are doing to attract students, and how students respond. Looking at both sides will make the findings richer and more reliable. Focusing on newly established colleges will also produce insights that can help similar colleges elsewhere in the country to improve their enrolment.

3.4 Sampling Design and Techniques

3.4.1 Sampling Frame

The sampling frame is the list from which respondents will be selected. For students, it will be the official enrolment registers kept by the registrar's office in each of the six colleges for the current academic year. For staff, it will be the staff lists of personnel assigned to admissions, marketing committees and community outreach.

3.4.2 Sample Size Determination

To make sure the student sample represents the wider student body, the sample size will be calculated using Yamane's formula for finite populations. The formula takes into account the total number of students in the six colleges and a margin of error of five per cent. This will give a sample large enough to support multiple regression analysis without making data collection unnecessarily large.

For administrative and marketing staff, no sampling will be done. Instead, a census will be used. Because the number of admissions and marketing officers in the six new colleges is small, every eligible staff member will be invited to take part. This removes sampling error for this group and captures the full range of staff views.

3.4.3 Sampling Technique

To make sure that each college is properly represented, students will be selected using stratified random sampling, with each of the six colleges treated as a separate stratum.

Stratification will prevent larger colleges, such as Nachu TVC, from dominating the sample at the expense of smaller ones, such as Githunguri TVC. The total student sample will first be divided among the six colleges in proportion to their enrolment. Within each college, students will then be chosen by simple random sampling, for

example by computer-generated random numbers applied to the registration list. In this way, every first-year student will have an equal chance of being selected, which reduces selection bias.

3.5 Data Collection Instruments

Primary data will be collected using structured questionnaires only. A structured questionnaire ensures that every respondent answers the same questions, worded in the same way, which makes the responses easier to compare statistically.

Most questions will use a **5-point Likert scale**, on which respondents indicate how much they agree or disagree with each statement, from Strongly Disagree to Strongly Agree. The scale turns people's experiences, perceptions and attitudes into numbers that can be analysed statistically.

3.6 Data Collection Procedures

Data collection will follow clear steps to ensure transparency and integrity. After the proposal has been approved by the Mount Kenya University postgraduate board, the researcher will apply for a research permit from the National Commission for Science, Technology and Innovation (NACOSTI).

With these documents, the researcher will visit the principals of the six colleges to obtain permission to collect data. Data will be collected both online and by trained research assistants, who will hand out the questionnaires in the colleges. Students will fill in and return the questionnaires during scheduled class breaks. Because administrative staff are often busy, a drop-and-pick-later method will be used for them, giving them several days to complete the questionnaire without disrupting their work.

3.7 Pilot Testing

Before the main data collection, a pilot study will be carried out to test the questionnaire. It will involve a small group of respondents equal to ten per cent of the total sample. The pilot will take place in a public TVET institution in Nairobi County, outside Kiambu, so that respondents in the main study are not exposed to the questions beforehand.

3.7.1 Validity of the Instruments

Validity is the extent to which an instrument measures what it is meant to measure. Content validity will be ensured by linking each questionnaire item to the study objectives, research questions and variables in the conceptual framework, so that none of the marketing channels is left out. Construct validity will be supported by basing all questions on established marketing and behavioural theories, so that concepts such as “digital engagement” and “marketing effectiveness” are expressed as practical, observable actions.

3.7.2 Reliability of the Instruments

Reliability is the extent to which the questionnaire produces consistent results when used repeatedly under similar conditions. The pilot data will be used to calculate Cronbach’s alpha (α) for each section of the questionnaire, which shows how closely the items in a section are related to one another. A coefficient of 0.70 or higher is generally accepted as reliable in the social sciences. Any item that lowers the reliability of its section during the pilot will be reworded or removed before the final questionnaire is printed.

3.8 Data Analysis and Presentation

Once the questionnaires have been collected, they will be checked for incomplete or inconsistent answers, then coded and entered into the computer. The data will then be analysed in two stages, using descriptive and inferential statistics.

3.8.1 Descriptive Statistics: Frequencies, percentages, means and standard deviations will be used to summarise the data, describe the respondents and show how visible each marketing channel is across the county.

3.8.2 Inferential Statistics: This stage goes beyond description to test relationships between the variables and to predict enrolment trends.

Pearson Correlation Analysis: This will be used to find the direction and strength of the relationship between each marketing channel and student enrolment.

Multiple Linear Regression Analysis: This will be the main method of analysis. It will show how the four marketing channels (digital, broadcast, outdoor and experiential) together influence enrolment. The regression coefficients will indicate which channel contributes most to enrolment and

whether the combined effect of the integrated framework is statistically significant.

Diagnostic Tests

Before the regression results are interpreted, three diagnostic tests will be carried out to confirm that the data meet the basic assumptions of regression:

1. **Normality Testing:** This will confirm that the data are normally distributed, which is a requirement for parametric tests. It will be checked using statistical tests and normal probability plots.
2. **Multicollinearity Testing:** This will confirm that the four independent variables are not too closely related to one another. If two channels are very highly correlated, it becomes impossible to separate their individual effects on enrolment. The test will use the **Variance Inflation Factor (VIF)**, and values well below the accepted threshold will show that each channel contributes distinct information.
3. **Linearity Testing:** Scatter plots will be used to confirm that the relationship between the marketing channels and student enrolment is linear, as the regression model assumes.

3.9 Ethical Considerations

To protect the rights of respondents and uphold academic integrity, the study will observe the following ethical principles:

1. **Informed Consent:** Taking part will be entirely voluntary. Before receiving a questionnaire, every respondent will be given a clear explanation of the purpose of the study, and anyone may withdraw at any stage without penalty.
2. **Anonymity and Confidentiality:** To encourage honest answers, respondents will not be asked for their names, identity card numbers or any other identifying details. All data will be combined and reported only as overall statistics.
3. **Protection from Plagiarism:** All literature, theories and secondary data used in the study will be properly cited using the appropriate referencing style,

and the final document will be checked using the university's plagiarism detection software.

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APPENDIX I: RESEARCH QUESTIONNAIRES

QUESTIONNAIRE 1: FIRST-YEAR STUDENTS

Research Project Title

Influence of Integrated Marketing Communications on Student Enrollment in Newly Established Public TVET Institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya

Introduction & Consent Note

Dear Student,

This questionnaire is part of an academic research project that looks at how different marketing and communication channels (online platforms, radio and TV, billboards, and school visits and roadshows) influenced your decision to join this college.

Your participation is completely voluntary. Please **do not** write your name anywhere on this questionnaire. Your responses will be kept strictly confidential and used only for academic analysis. Thank you for your time and participation.

SECTION A: DEMOGRAPHIC INFORMATION

Kindly check (✓) or fill out the appropriate option.

1. Indicate gender

- ☐ [] Male
- ☐ [] Female
- ☐ [] Prefer not to say

2. What is your current age bracket?

(Note: Age data is collected to evaluate how different marketing and communication channels appeal across distinct age groups).

- ☐ [] Under 20 years
- ☐ [] 20 – 24 years
- ☐ [] 25 – 29 years
- ☐ [] 30 years and above

3. Which institution are you currently enrolled in?

- ☐ [] Lari Technical and Vocational College
- ☐ [] Githunguri Technical and Vocational College
- ☐ [] Ruiru Technical and Vocational College
- ☐ [] Limuru Technical and Vocational College
- ☐ [] Gatundu South Technical and Vocational College
- ☐ [] Nachu Technical and Vocational College

4. **What program level are you currently studying?**

- ☐ [] Artisan Certificate
- ☐ [] Craft Certificate
- ☐ [] Diploma

SECTIONS B TO F: STUDY VARIABLES

Please indicate your level of agreement with each statement by ticking (\$\checkmark\$) the number that best reflects your view.

Scale: 1 = Strongly Disagree (SD) | 2 = Disagree (D) | 3 = Neutral (N) | 4 = Agree (A) | 5 = Strongly Agree (SA)

No.	Statement	1 (SD)	2 (D)	3 (N)	4 (A)	5 (SA)
B	DIGITAL MARKETING STRATEGIES					
1.	Social media platforms (e.g., Facebook, TikTok, WhatsApp) were my primary source of initial information about this college.					
2.	Information regarding courses and fees on the college website is clear and easy to understand.					
3.	The college website content is consistently kept up-to-date.					
4.	Text messages (SMS) received from the college influenced my decision to					

No.	Statement	1 (SD)	2 (D)	3 (N)	4 (A)	5 (SA)
	submit an application.					
5.	Online interactions with the college's digital pages increased my confidence in registering here.					
C	BROADCAST MEDIA ADVERTISING					
6.	Radio advertisements or talk shows on national or local stations increased my awareness of this college.					
7.	Television advertisements or news features showcasing modern campus facilities influenced my choice to enroll.					
8.	Broadcast media announcements persuaded me that TVET courses lead to viable career opportunities.					
9.	Radio information played a major role in convincing my parents/sponsors to support my studies here.					
D	OUTDOOR MEDIA					

No.	Statement	1 (SD)	2 (D)	3 (N)	4 (A)	5 (SA)
	ADVERTISING					
10.	Directional signboards along highways helped me easily locate the physical campus.					
11.	Highway billboards made the college highly recognizable to prospective students.					
12.	Banners and posters in market centers effectively highlighted upcoming intake dates.					
13.	Printed brochures and flyers provided helpful details about course admission requirements.					
14.	Physical branding on campus gates and walls creates a professional image.					
E	EXPERIENTIAL OUTREACH STRATEGIES					
15.	High school career day visits by college representatives generated					

No.	Statement	1 (SD)	2 (D)	3 (N)	4 (A)	5 (SA)
	my initial interest in technical training.					
16.	Community roadshows and caravans helped clarify my doubts about vocational education.					
17.	Direct interaction with college representatives at community gatherings motivated me to join.					
18.	Live skill demonstrations during public events made technical courses appealing to me.					
F	STUDENT ENROLLMENT DECISION					
19.	Promotional activities directly prompted my decision to submit an admission application.					
20.	Institutional marketing materials positively shifted my perception of TVET education.					
21.	Overall, I am satisfied with my decision to enroll					

No.	Statement	1 (SD)	2 (D)	3 (N)	4 (A)	5 (SA)
	based on the information communicated to me.					

Thank you for your valuable participation!

QUESTIONNAIRE 2: ADMINISTRATIVE & MARKETING STAFF

Research Project Title

Influence of Integrated Marketing Communications on Student Enrollment in Newly Established Public TVET Institutions in Kiambu County, Kenya

Introduction & Consent Note

Dear Respondent,

This questionnaire is part of an MBA research project that looks at how well marketing communication is coordinated in public TVET institutions and how it affects enrolment.

Because of your role in the college, your experience is very valuable to this study. Your identity will remain anonymous, and all information will be reported only in combined form. Thank you for your cooperation.

SECTION A: BACKGROUND PROFILE

Kindly check (√) or fill out the appropriate option.

1. What is your specific department or role?

- o ☐ Admissions Office
- o ☐ Registry / Academic Affairs
- o ☐ Public Relations / Marketing Committee

- o ☐ Other (Please specify): _____

2. How long have you worked within the TVET sub-sector?

- o ☐ Less than 2 years
- o ☐ 2 – 5 years
- o ☐ Above 5 years

3. Name of your current station/institution:

- o ☐ Lari Technical and Vocational College
- o ☐ Githunguri Technical and Vocational College
- o ☐ Ruiru Technical and Vocational College
- o ☐ Limuru Technical and Vocational College
- o ☐ Gatundu South Technical and Vocational College
- o ☐ Nachu Technical and Vocational College

SECTIONS B TO F: INSTITUTIONAL MARKETING METRICS

Please indicate your level of agreement with the following statements regarding your institution's practices.

Scale: 1 = Strongly Disagree (SD) | 2 = Disagree (D) | 3 = Neutral (N) | 4 = Agree (A) | 5 = Strongly Agree (SA)

No.	Statement	1 (SD)	2 (D)	3 (N)	4 (A)	5 (SA)
B	DIGITAL MARKETING EXECUTION					
1.	The institution allocates adequate budgetary resources for digital marketing channels.					
2.	Social media platforms are updated frequently to engage prospective					

No.	Statement	1 (SD)	2 (D)	3 (N)	4 (A)	5 (SA)
	applicants.					
3.	Online application portals are functional and streamline the admission process.					
4.	Bulk SMS messaging systems are used effectively to follow up on prospective student inquiries.					
C	BROADCAST MEDIA MARKETING					
5.	Local vernacular radio stations are utilized to reach parents and sponsors.					
6.	Radio broadcasts and talk shows are scheduled to align with key placement and intake periods.					
7.	Budgetary constraints restrict the institution's ability to run television ad campaigns.					
D	OUTDOOR MEDIA IMPLEMENTATION					

No.	Statement	1 (SD)	2 (D)	3 (N)	4 (A)	5 (SA)
8.	Directional signboards and banners are strategically placed across major market centers.					
9.	Print materials (flyers/brochures) are regularly distributed to build local awareness.					
10.	Updates to physical campus branding have enhanced the institution's image in the community.					
E	EXPERIENTIAL OUTREACH ACTIONS					
11.	Management prioritizes school visits to recruit completing secondary school students.					
12.	Interactive roadshows and caravans lead to immediate increases in student inquiries.					
13.	Direct face-to-face interaction is an effective strategy for addressing cultural stigmas against TVET.					

No.	Statement	1 (SD)	2 (D)	3 (N)	4 (A)	5 (SA)
F	MARKETING FRAMEWORK & ENROLLMENT OUTCOMES					
14.	Promotional campaigns are typically run as standalone activities rather than a synchronized IMC effort.					
15.	The institution lacks empirical data on which communication channel yields the highest recruitment return.					
16.	A fully integrated, multi-channel marketing campaign correlates directly with increased student intake.					

SECTION G: OPEN-ENDED ADMINISTRATIVE INSIGHTS

Kindly provide brief descriptive answers based on your practical experience at this institution.

1. In your opinion, which single communication channel or outreach strategy generates the highest volume of actual student enrollments at your college? Briefly explain why.
2. What primary challenge does your institution face when coordinating digital marketing activities?
3. What primary challenge does your institution face when executing physical outreach and broadcast campaigns?

Thank you for supporting this research project!

